Basic Pizza Dough - By Hand Method

Homemade dough for two 12-inch pizzas or four calzones · From Food Network (Emeril Lagasse)



Illustration

Makes 2 (12-inch) pizzas, serving 4
Prep 5 min
Cook 30 min
Total 36 min (plus rising)

INGREDIENTS

- 1 package active dry yeast
- 1 cup warm water (110 degrees F.)
- 2 1/2 to 3 cups flour plus more if necessary
- 1 1/2 teaspoons salt
- 1 1/2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil

STEPS

1. In a large bowl, combine yeast with water, olive oil, salt and stir well to proof. After 5 minutes, add half of the flour and mix well. Add all remaining flour except 1/2 cup and mix well with your hands.
2. Transfer dough to a lightly floured work surface and knead for at least 5 and up to 7 minutes, adding enough additional flour as necessary to form a smooth and elastic dough. Dough should not be sticky.
3. Transfer dough to a lightly oiled 2 or 3 quart bowl and turn to coat with oil. Cover with a damp towel and let rise in a warm place until doubled in size, usually at least 1 hour.
4. Preheat oven to 500 degrees F. and if you have one, place a pizza stone on the bottom rack of the oven.
5. Divide dough into 2 portions and form into balls. Place on a lightly oiled baking sheet, cover with a damp towel, and let rest 15 minutes. Transfer to a lightly floured surface, shape as desired and roll out to 1/4-inch thick.
6. Transfer dough to a pizza peel and top with toppings of choice. Transfer to the preheated pizza stone and bake until crispy and golden brown, usually 12 to 18 minutes (depending on the toppings). Remove with a metal peel or spatula and serve immediately.

Calzones: divide the dough into 4 equal portions and form into 4 balls. Place on a lightly oiled baking sheet, cover with a damp towel and rest 15 minutes, then roll out into 4 6-inch circles. Place filling in the center of one side of each circle, fold dough over to meet the edges, crimp with a fork or your fingers, and cut a small slit in the top. Cook on a preheated pizza stone in a preheated 475 degree oven for about 8 to 10 minutes, or until well-browned. Serve immediately.

> **Heart-healthy tip:** Go heavy on the veggie toppings and use less cheese, and skip sausage and pepperoni. Grilled chicken works well.